

natural philosophy, natural magic, and other magical forms. Mirandola's *Oration on the Dignity of Man* started with a quote from Marsilio Ficino's *Asclepius* and was written to accompany his own controversial 1486 text *900 Conclusions*, which proposed that Christ's divine nature could be proven by magic and Kabbalah (see pp.136–139).

Outside the Italian city-states, Renaissance scientist-occultists also borrowed from Hermeticism, including Robert Fludd in England, who interlaced astrology with Hermetic thought; adviser to Elizabeth I, John Dee; and Sir Isaac Newton, who had a great interest in alchemy. Swiss physician Paracelsus, founder of modern medicine,

linked diseases to the damaging influence of certain stars in the Hermetic united universe. Like Paracelsus, Cornelius Agrippa saw magic as a key to the meaning of life and considered Hermes Trismegistus to be one of the first authorities on magic. Hermeticism had an impact on later occult movements, too, such as the 19th-century Hermetic Order of the Golden Dawn (see pp.242–243).

▼ Uniting the universe

Robert Fludd's diagram (c. 1617) shows the microcosm of man, or human life, within the macrocosm of the greater universe. Fludd's microcosm listed the four personality types, while his macrocosm included the sun, moon, and planets, as well as higher divine beings.

